

Unicon OpenGL 2D and 2D/3D Graphics User's Guide

Gigi Young and Clinton Jeffery

Unicon Technical Report: 22

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Unicon Project
<http://unicon.org>
University of Idaho
Department of Computer Science
Moscow, ID, 83844, USA

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<http://unicon.org>

University of Idaho

Department of Computer Science

Moscow, ID, 83844, USA

New Mexico Institute of Mines and Technology

Department of Computer Science and Engineering

Socorro, NM, 87801, USA

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Introduction

| A new OpenGL-based implementation of 2D graphics facilities in Version
13.3 of | Unicon introduces new features, such as a display list architecture in-
herited from | the 3D facilities and an integrated 2D/3D graphics mode. This
report describes the | new features provided by the OpenGL-based implemen-
tation of Unicon's graphics | facilities. This report supplements IPD268a [1]
for Unicon's 2D facilities and UTR9d | [2] for Unicon's 3D facilities. The
reader should consult [3] for additional details on | this implementation.

The OpenGL-based 2D facilities described in this report have thusfar only
been

| implemented and tested on Linux systems. The OpenGL 2D and 2D/3D
facilities are | enabled by installing the OpenGL and FreeType development
headers and libraries | prior to configuring and building Unicon. Additionally,
Linux systems require the | installation of X11 development headers and
libraries. The source code is configured | when OpenGL graphics appears in
the unicon -features listing.

The OpenGL graphics implementation is toggled on/off by setting/unsetting
the

| environment variable UNICONGL2D. Use mode "g" with function open() to open a | 2D-only window and mode "gl" to open an integrated 2D/3D window.

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2D Features

| The OpenGL implementation of the 2D facilities introduces a display list architecture | and transparency that will be familiar to users of Unicon's 3D facilities. These two | primary added features and a number of smaller items augment Unicon's previous | 2D graphics feature set. While great effort has been made to preserve compatibility | with Unicon's other 2D graphics implementations, a few changes can be observed.

2.1

Display List

| The display list of the 2D facilities is a list of records. Every record on the display | list possesses the field name which contains the string literal identifying its record | type. Most Unicon 2D graphics functions create and append corresponding graphics | records to the display list. See Section 4 in this report for details on display list | records and their corresponding graphics functions.

Graphics function WindowContents() returns a reference to the display list. The

| reference to the most recently generated display list record can be obtained by grab- | bing the last element of the display list after returning from a successful call to a | Unicon graphics procedure that creates a display list record.

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| DrawRectangle(0,0,100,100) | drawrect := WindowContents()[-1]

The display list can be modified by the user. It may contain only records in the

format specified in Section 4. Failure to comply will result in a run-time error.

2.1.1

Animation

| The display list allows for intuitive animation. References to primitives on the display | list can be used to modify position, color, text, font, and more without needed to | write specialized drawing procedures for changing these attributes. See Section 4 | in this report (Modifiable Display List Record Fields) for details on which fields of | display list records are modifiable.

Changes to display list record fields only become visible when the runtime system redraws the screen, such as when the program calls the function Refresh().

All graphical primitives except FillPolygon, DrawPolygon, DrawLine, DrawSegment, and DrawPoint have x and y (positional) fields to be used for modifying the position of a particular primitive.

```
drawrect.x += 5 | drawrect.y += 5 | Refresh()
```

For graphical primitives that do not possess positional fields, the translational

coordinates dx and dy can be used instead. Display list records Dx and Dy affect the translational coordinates of all subsequent graphical primitives until another translational display list record of the same type is encountered. Thus, Dx and Dy can be used to translate groups of primitives. This is more efficient than modifying each x and y for each graphical primitive that possesses those fields.

Context attribute display list records are created and appended to the display

list by WAttrib() in order of the argument list given. Only assignments create display list records. However, all records are created before the first suspension of WAttrib().

```
dl := WindowContents() | WAttrib("dx=0","dy=0") | dx := dl[-2] | dy := dl[-1] | DrawPolygon(0,0,0,100,100,100,100,0)
```

```
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```

```
| DrawLine(0,0,100,100) | DrawLine(0,100,100,0)
```

```
| dx.val += 5 | dy.val += 5 | Refresh()
```

Another technique is to build a list of references to display list records that need

to be modified in a render loop. A case expression can be used on the name field of the records to differentiate between the types of records. The following program uses an animation loop which results in a color-shifting, filled circle that bounces off the walls of the window.

```
link graphics | $include "keysyms.icn"
procedure main()
| width := height := 400 | L := [] | &window := open("simple animation",
"g", "size=" || width || "x" || height) | dl := WindowContents()
| WAttrib("fg=red") | put(L, dl[-1]) | FillCircle(10,200,10) | put(L, dl[-1])
| dirx := diry := 1 | speed := .1 | repeat {
if *Pending() > 0 then {
```

```

case Event() of {
| "q": exit(0) | }
}
else every obj := !L do {
case obj.name of {
"FillCircle": {
if (obj.x + dirx*(obj.r + speed) > width) then
3
dirx := -1
else if (obj.x + dirx*(obj.r + speed) < 0) then
dirx := 1
if (obj.y + diry*(obj.r + speed) > height) then
diry := -1
else if (obj.y + diry*(obj.r + speed) < 0) then
diry := 1
| obj.x += speeddirx / obj.y += speeddiry | }
"Fg": {
| tmp := obj.r | obj.r := obj.g | obj.g := obj.b | obj.b := tmp | }
}
}
| WDelay(1) | Refresh() | }
end

```

2.1.2

Optimizing Performance

| Graphics facilities that utilize a display list should provide a mechanism by which to | manage the list size. For Unicon, graphics functions CopyArea() and EraseArea() | may be used to truncate the display list, preventing the display list from growing | indefinitely.

Calling CopyArea() with positional and dimensional arguments to cover the en-

| tire destination window will delete the destination window's display list and add a | CopyArea display list record. Calling EraseArea() with positional and dimensional | arguments to cover the entire window will cause the display list to be deleted without | appending a new display list record. These uses of CopyArea() and EraseArea() are | useful when previous rendering operations are fully obscured and no longer needed.

EraseArea() is useful when previous rendering operations are fully obscured and

| no longer needed. On the other hand, CopyArea() can be used to condense multiple | rendering operations into one display list record as long as animation is no longer

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| needed for any part of the area copied. CopyArea() can also be used to reduce the | number of items on the display list for any portion of the window smaller than its | maximum dimensions if the obscured items are removed manually.

2.2

Transparency

| Transparency is denoted by the alpha value, which ranges from 0 (fully transparent) | to 1 (fully opaque). To ensure proper transparency blending, any transparent objects | should be drawn in the correct order, i.e. objects that appear farther away should | be drawn first. Once drawn in the correct order, the display list will preserve the | order, unless the ordering list is modified by the user.

2.2.1

Color Specification

| Transparency can be specified explicitly within a color specification in a few different | ways. The first of which is a transparency modifier that prepends the usual Unicon | color name string. The available transparency modifiers are in the following table | taken from [2].

Transparency name

percent visible

opaque

100

dull, a.k.a. subtranslucent

75

translucent

50

subtransparent

25

transparent

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| Alternatively, the transparency modifier can be a floating-point number from (0, 1]. | If the transparency modifier is 0, then the value of context attribute alpha is | used. If the transparency modifier is greater than 1, then an alpha of 1 is used. | Thus, Fg("translucent red") is equivalent to Fg("0.5

red"). The alpha value | can also be set by defining RGBA values directly, such as Fg("#FF000080") or | Fg("#65535,0,0,32768").

2.2.2

Context Attribute

| The OpenGL implementation introduces a new context attribute, alpha, which has | a default value of 1 (fully opaque). alpha denotes the alpha value of a color spec- | ification which does not explicitly assign transparency, i.e. "red" or "#FF0000". | Thus,

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```
WAttrib("alpha=0.5", "fg=red", "bg=black")
```

| would assign an alpha value of 0.5 to both the fg and bg colors. However, if alpha | values are specified in the color phrase

```
WAttrib("alpha=0.5", "fg=0.4 red", "bg=0.7 black")
```

then the value of alpha is ignored.

2.2.3

Modifying Display List Record Fields

| The third way is by modifying the alpha field, a, of a Fg or Bg display list record | (see Section 4 in this report for more details).

```
| Fg("red") | fg := WindowContents()[-1] | fg.a := 32768 | Refresh()
```

| It should be noted that the RGBA fields of Fg and Bg display list records are 16-bit | integers ranging from 0 to 65535 opposed to the alpha values ranging from 0.0 to | 1.0. To apply the alpha (or color) change, simply use the library function Refresh(). | This is also an alternative to using native mutable colors.

2.2.4

A Simple Program

| To bring everything together, the following program phases three colored rectangles | in and out in a loop.

```
| link graphics | $include "keysyms.icn"
```

```
procedure main()
```

```
local const := 0.01, incr1, incr2, incr3, alpha1, alpha2, alpha3,
```

```
fg1, fg2, fg3
```

```
| incr1 := incr2 := incr3 := const | &window := open("", "g", "size=200,200", "bg=black")
```

```
| Fg("blue") | fg1 := WindowContents()[-1] | alpha1 := fg1.a/65535.0
```

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```
FillRectangle(25,25,150,150)
```

```
| Fg("0.67 green") | fg2 := WindowContents()[-1] | alpha2 := fg2.a/65535.0
```

```
| FillRectangle(50,50,100,100)
```

```

    | Fg("0.33 red") | fg3 := WindowContents()[-1] | alpha3 := fg3.a/65535.0
| FillRectangle(75,75,50,50) | Refresh()
    repeat {
    if \*Pending() > 0 then
    case Event() of {
    | "q": exit() | }
    else {
    WDelay(10)
    | if alpha1 >= 1.0 then incr1 := -const | else if alpha1 <= 0 then incr1
:= const | alpha1 += incr1
    | if alpha2 >= 1.0 then incr2 := -const | else if alpha2 <= 0 then incr2
:= const | alpha2 += incr2
    | if alpha3 >= 1.0 then incr3 := -const | else if alpha3 <= 0 then incr3
:= const | alpha3 += incr3
    | fg1.a := alpha165535 / fg2.a := alpha265535 | fg3.a := alpha3*65535 |
Refresh() | }

```

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}

end

2.3

Fonts

| The OpenGL-based implementation uses FreeType for font rasterization, which now | allows for family in the font string format family[,styles],size to specify a | TrueType or OpenType font file. Both library functions WAttrib() and Font() can | be used to select a user-specified font file with

```
WAttrib("font=mymonofont.ttf,18")
```

or

```
Font("mymonofont.ttf,18")
```

The semantics of font specification remains otherwise unchanged.

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Integrated 2D/3D Features

| The integrated 2D/3D facilities are an optional extension to Unicon's 3D mode, the | mode obtained by passing "gl" to open(). The semantics of the integrated graphics | mode can be imagined by looking through the lens of a camera. The lens (near plane), | contains all 2D rendering, while the rest of the space (viewing volume) contains all | 3D rendering. Effectively, 3D windows now have an additional display list for 2D | primitives, and an

integrated 2D/3D window is a 3D window in which the 2D display | list is non-empty.

Figure 1: Orthogonal viewing volume

Figure 2: Perspective viewing volume

3.1

Canvas Attribute projection

| The canvas attribute projection was added to give the option of selecting an orthog- | onal (one-to-one) or perspective (foreshortening) projection for the viewing volume. | The call WAttrib("projection=ortho") selects an orthogonal projection while the | call WAttrib("projection=perspec") selects a perspective projection. The default | value of attribute projection is "projection=perspec". Changes to viewing vol- | ume projection can be applied by calling Refresh().

3.2

Canvas Attribute camwidth

| To give more control over the camera (viewing volume) dimensions, an additional can- | vas attribute camwidth was added. By adjusting the camera width with camwidth, | the camera height is implicitly calculated based on the ratio of window width to | height. camwidth cannot be given a value less than or equal to 0. Assigning 0 to | camwidth causes WAttrib() to fail, while assigning a negative value to camwidth | causes its absolute value to be assigned. Changes to camera dimensions can be | applied by calling Refresh().

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3.3

Context Attribute rendermode

| The new context attribute rendermode dictates whether 2D or 3D rendering is ac- | tive. The semantics of the 2D and 3D graphics facilities remain unaffected by the | integrated graphics mode. WAttrib("rendermode=2d") activates 2D rendering and | WAttrib("rendermode=3d") activates 3D rendering. By default, "rendermode=3d" | for mode "gl". If a graphics function is used in the incorrect render mode, a run-time | error will occur.

WAttrib("rendermode=2d")

Activate 2D rendering

| DrawPolygon(...) | WAttrib("rendermode=3d")

Activate 3D rendering

DrawPolygon(...)

For graphics function `Clone()`, `rendermode` defaults to the value of the source

| context unless specified by the passed argument list. `Clone()` can be used to bind a | new context to the canvas to alleviate the need to call `WAttrib()` to switch render | modes. The following example designates a window each for 2D and 3D rendering.

```
| w3d := open("", "gl", ...) | w2d := Clone(w3d, "rendermode=2d", ...)
| DrawPolygon(w2d, ...) # Draw in 2D mode | DrawPolygon(w3d, ...)
# Draw in 3D mode
```

`WindowContents()` returns the display list of the corresponding render-mode. Both

```
| w3d := open("", "gl", ...) | w2d := Clone(w3d, "rendermode=2d", ...)
| ... | dl := WindowContents(w2d)
and
| &window := open("", "gl", ...) | ... | WAttrib("rendermode=2d") | dl
:= WindowContents()
```

| return the 2D display list. Graphics function `Refresh()` redraws both (2D and | 3D) display lists, if available. If a display list is empty, it is ignored. `Eye()`, a | 3D graphics function, performs an implicit `Refresh()` in addition to changing the | camera attributes.

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Modifiable Display List Record Fields

| The display list records with their modifiable fields are shown as Unicon record | declarations.

Every display list record has the field name, containing the string

| literal which identifies it. name should not be modified. It is shown here as useful | information rather than a modifiable field. If no fields other than name are shown, | it means that no modifiable fields are available. It is possible to query the fields of | these records at runtime, but modifying any fields other than the ones shown in this | section will result in undefined behavior.

4.1

Primitives

gl2d blimage: record

`DrawImage()`

| name: "BilevelImage", | x: Real, y: Real, width: Int, height: Int,

gl2d readimage: record

```

ReadImage()
| name: "ReadImage", | x: Real, y: Real, width: Int, height: Int,
gl2d strimage: record
DrawImage()/ReadImage()
| name: "StringImage", | x: Real, y: Real, width: Int, height: Int,
gl2d drawstring: record
DrawString()
| name: "DrawString", | x: Real, y: Real, s: Int
gl2d wwwrite: record
WWrite*()
| name: "WWrite", | x: Real, y: Real, s: Int
gl2d copyarea: record
CopyArea()
| name: "CopyArea", | x: Real, y: Real,
x and y define the coordinates of the destination window.
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gl2d erasearea: record
EraseArea()
| name: "EraseArea", | x: Real, y: Real, width: Real, height: Real
gl2d fillpolygon: record
FillPolygon()
name: "FillPolygon"
gl2d drawpolygon: record
DrawPolygon()
name: "DrawPolygon"
gl2d drawline: record
DrawCurve()/DrawLine()
name: "DrawLine"
gl2d drawsegment: record
DrawSegment()
name: "DrawSegment"
gl2d drawpoint: record
DrawPoint()
name: "DrawPoint"
gl2d drawcircle: record
DrawCircle()
| name: "DrawCircle", | x: Real, y: Real, r: Real, theta: Real, alpha:
Real

```

```

gl2d fillcircle: record
FillCircle()
| name: "FillCircle", | x: Real, y: Real, r: Real, theta: Real, alpha: Real
gl2d drawarc: record
DrawArc()
| name: "DrawArc", | x: Real, y: Real, width: Real, height: Real, theta:
Real, alpha: Real
gl2d fillarc: record
FillArc()
| name: "FillArc", | x: Real, y: Real, width: Real, height: Real, theta:
Real, alpha: Real
gl2d drawrectangle: record
DrawRectangle()
| name: "DrawRectangle", | x: Real, y: Real, width: Real, height: Real
gl2d fillrectangle: record
FillRectangle()
| name: "FillRectangle", | x: Real, y: Real, width: Real, height: Real
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4.2
Context Attributes
gl2d fg: record
WAttrib()/Fg()
| name: "Fg", | r: Int, g: Int, b: Int, a: Int
gl2d bg: record
WAttrib()/Bg()
| name: "Bg", | r: Int, g: Int, b: Int, a: Int
gl2d reverse: record
WAttrib()
name: "Reverse"
gl2d gamma: record
WAttrib()
| name: "Gamma", | val: Real
gl2d drawop: record
WAttrib()
| name: "Drawop", | s: String
gl2d font: record
WAttrib()/Font()
| name: "Font", | s: String

```

```

gl2d leading: record
WAttrib()
| name: "Leading", | val: Int
gl2d linewidth: record
WAttrib()
| name: "Linewidth", | val: Int
gl2d linestyle: record
WAttrib()
| name: "Linestyle", | s: String
gl2d fillstyle: record
WAttrib()
| name: "Fillstyle", | s: String
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gl2d pattern: record
WAttrib()
| name: "Pattern", | s: String
gl2d clip: record
WAttrib()
| name: "Clip", | x: Int, y: Int, width: Int, height: Int
gl2d dx: record
WAttrib()
| name: "Dx", | val: Int
gl2d dy: record
WAttrib()
| name: "Dy", | val: Int

```

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References

- | [1] Gregg M. Townsend, Ralph E. Griswold, Clinton L. Jeffery (1995) Graphic Facilities for the Icon Programming Language. IPD268a, Department of Computer Science, The University of Arizona. Available at <https://www2.cs.arizona.edu/icon/ftp/doc/ipd268.pdf> \ [Verified 21 Oct 2020]
- | [2] Naomi Martinez, Clinton Jeffery, Jafar Al Gharaibeh (2017) Unicon 3D Graphics User's Guide and Reference Manual. UTR9d, University of Idaho, Moscow, ID 83844. Available at <http://unicon.org/utr/utr9.pdf> \ [Verified 21 Oct 2020]

| [3] Kevin Z. Young (2020) Unicon’s OpenGL 2D and Integrated 2D/3D Graphics | Implementation. University of Idaho, Moscow Idaho. Available at <http://unicon.org/reports/young.pdf> \ [Verified 30 Oct 2020]

| [4] Ralph Griswold, Clinton Jeffery, and Gregg Townsend (1998) Graphics Program- | ming in Icon.

Peer to Peer Communications, San Jose CA. Available at <http://www2.cs.arizona.edu/icon/ftp/doc/gblup.pdf> \ [Verified 24 Nov 2020]

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A

Platform Differences

| Unicon’s OpenGL-based 2D implementation strives to be backwards-compatible with | its X11-based predecessor and run existing Unicon 2D graphics applications as-is. | Platform differences between Unicon 2D implementations do exist but great effort is | made to minimize them; see Appendix N of [4]. The OpenGL 2D implementation | achieves compatibility that is as good or better than most other ports of Unicon’s | 2D graphics, such as the MS Windows port.

This appendix summarizes the most relevant information to the Unicon program-

| mer from [3]. See Section 5 from [3] for a more detailed evaluation of the OpenGL | 2D implementation.

A.1

Graphical Accuracy

| Due to semantic differences between OpenGL and platform-native APIs, there are | minor differences in the appearance of some primitives, especially fonts and lines. | Additional graphical differences occur on different OpenGL implementations, such | as Nvidia hardware-based rendering versus Mesa software rendering.

The following figures depict the differences in rendering between the X11 imple-

| mentation and the OpenGL implementation with Mesa and Nvidia OpenGL drivers | through the Unicon program gpxtest.

Figure 3: gpxtest (Xlib)

Figure 4: gpxtest (Mesa)

Figure 5: gpxtest (Nvidia)

A.1.1

Fonts

| The migration to FreeType for font rasterization requires the use of font files which | differ from native X11 fonts. Consequently, the four supported Unicon font names— | mono, typewriter, sans, and serif—use different base fonts. It is possible for users | to load a specific font if needed by providing their own TrueType or OpenType font | files. See Section 2.3 (Fonts) for more details.

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Figure 6:

gpxtest dialog
(Xlib)

Figure 7:

gpxtest dialog
(Mesa)

Figure 8:

gpxtest dialog
(Nvidia)

A.1.2

Lines

| The OpenGL implementation currently lacks a quality algorithm for rendering thick | lines (linewidth greater than 1) in addition to capping and joining thick lines. Minor | differences in arcs and circles should be expected due to differences the algorithm | between the OpenGL and X11 implemen-

A.2

Performance

| The OpenGL 2D implementation's performance is different than the X11 implemen- | tation. The OpenGL implementation is faster on some operations such as rendering | dashed lines of any type, while the X11 implemen-
tation excels at rendering normal | filled and unfilled geometric primitives, text strings, and copyareas.

Depending on the OpenGL driver used (e.g. Mesa vs. Nvidia), the X11 implemen-

| tation is anywhere from 3-5x faster than the OpenGL implementation on programs | that use a majority of filled and unfilled primitives (rectangles, arcs, circles, poly- | gons, and copyareas) with linestyle=solid and fillstyle=solid. This type of | primitive composition is most likely to reflect the average 2D graphics program.

A.3

What to Expect

This is the beta-test release of the OpenGL-based implementation for the 2D and integrated 2D/3D graphics facilities. The majority of existing Unicon 2D programs should work as expected under the OpenGL-based implementation. However, programs that periodically draw new graphics without erasing the window are likely to run into performance issues over time due to display list growth. To improve performance of legacy programs, see Section 2.1.2 (Optimizing Performance) in this report.

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